

# DET at CAR · Sunday 2026-10-04 20:20 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025.  $n \geq 10$ . No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

**Line:** DET -3.5 / CAR +3.5, total 50.5. Trip: DET → CAR 501 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: DET 7 days, CAR 7 days. Roof: outdoors.

## 1. Season boxes

| Wk | Team | Spot     | Score | Line | ATS   | Off yds | Rush | Pass EPA | Off EPA | Def EPA allowed | SR   | TO |
|----|------|----------|-------|------|-------|---------|------|----------|---------|-----------------|------|----|
| 1  | DET  | H vs NO  | 31–30 | -7.0 | miss  | 371     | 165  | +5.9     | -2.1    | +1.7            | 0.45 | 1  |
| 2  | DET  | A at BUF | 31–41 | +5.5 | miss  | 393     | 66   | +18.6    | +18.3   | +31.2           | 0.49 | 0  |
| 3  | DET  | H vs NYJ | 31–24 | -7.0 | push  | 400     | 131  | +12.1    | +12.6   | +7.1            | 0.60 | 0  |
| 1  | CAR  | H vs CHI | 37–59 | +3.0 | miss  | 486     | 125  | +15.1    | +8.8    | +27.0           | 0.47 | 3  |
| 2  | CAR  | A at ATL | 34–3  | -2.5 | cover | 355     | 68   | +11.1    | +2.3    | -33.5           | 0.40 | 0  |
| 3  | CAR  | A at CLE | 18–21 | -2.5 | miss  | 389     | 98   | -5.9     | -7.7    | +0.2            | 0.37 | 1  |

Last game EPA (PBP): DET off +12.6, def allowed +7.1, net +5.5, SR 0.60. CAR off -7.7, def allowed +0.2, net -7.9, SR 0.37. Records: DET 2–1, CAR 1–2. ATS: DET 0–2, CAR 1–2.

## 2. Lookahead and rest

- DET: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 7). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs ARI, non-division, Sunday late window.
- CAR: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 3). 7 days rest. Week 5: bye.

## 3. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: no
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: applies to CAR
- off a bye: no
- scored  $\leq 10$  last: no
- short week: no
- trip  $\geq 1000$  mi: no
- TO  $\geq 3$  last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

## 4. Stack, without double-counting

Header per chair is the walk-forward record: traits picked by max parent-minus-child gap on seasons before N at  $n \geq 10$ , printed on season N, N = 2019–2025, pooled. Every printed game is out of sample. The full-window stack (picked on all seasons at  $n \geq 20$ ) and its diagnostics sit in the block below it. Same gate on every slot.

Full-window stacks on both chairs resolve to the same games (mirror). The walk-forward folds pick traits per chair, so both blocks print.

- CAR +3.5** — one population: Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5. Not added (no gap with  $n \geq 20$  left): equal rest, off a loss, off a 1-score loss, off an ATS miss, off a loss as favorite, off a road game, scored  $\leq 21$  last, allowed  $\leq 21$  last....
- Walk-forward 10–4 (71.4%, n=14)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:5-3 20:2-0 21:1-0 22:0-0 23:1-0 24:1-1 25:0-0. OOS cover margin median +5.8,  $P(>+7)$  0.36,  $P(<-7)$  0.07. Traits picked in  $\geq 4$  of 7 folds: Sunday night home dog (6/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5. ATS 10–11 (47.6%, n=21).
- By season: 16:0-1 17:0-1 18:3-3 19:1-1 20:2-0 21:4-0 22:0-1 23:0-1 24:0-3
- Cover margin: median -0.5, q25/q75 -2.5/+5.5;  $P(>+7)$  0.14,  $P(<-7)$  0.19
- Anchor alone 10–11 (47.6%, n=21); anchor minus stack 0–0 (—, n=0)
- Stack by line bucket: +3.5 to +6.5 10–11 (47.6%, n=21)
- Contrary cross: allowed  $\leq 21$  last: 4–7 (36.4%, n=11) → in stack 4–7 (36.4%, n=11) | off a loss: 4–6 (40.0%, n=10) → in stack 4–6 (40.0%, n=10) | outdoors: 7–9 (43.8%, n=16) → in stack 7–9 (43.8%, n=16) | TO  $\leq 1$  last: 5–6 (45.5%, n=11) → in stack 5–6 (45.5%, n=11)

- **DET -3.5** — one population: Sunday night fav -3.5 to -6.5. Not added (no gap with n ≥ 20 left): equal rest, trip 200–1000 mi, 0 time zones, off a win, off a 1-score win, off a win as favorite, off a home game, scored 27–33 last....
- **Walk-forward 4–5 (44.4%, n=9)** — picked on seasons before N, printed on N, 2019–25. By year: 19:1-0 20:0-2 21:0-1 22:0-0 23:0-1 24:1-1 25:2-0. OOS cover margin median -4.0, P(>+7) 0.11, P(<-7) 0.22. Traits picked in ≥4 of 7 folds: Sunday night road favorite (6/7).
- Full-window stack (picked on all seasons): Sunday night fav -3.5 to -6.5. ATS 11–10 (52.4%, n=21).
- By season: 16:1-0 17:1-0 18:3-3 19:1-1 20:0-2 21:0-4 22:1-0 23:1-0 24:3-0
- Cover margin: median +0.5, q25/q75 -5.5/+2.5; P(>+7) 0.19, P(<-7) 0.14
- Anchor alone 11–10 (52.4%, n=21); anchor minus stack 0–0 (—, n=0)
- Stack by line bucket: -3.5 to -6.5 11–10 (52.4%, n=21)
- Contrary cross: off a win: 6–7 (46.2%, n=13) → in stack 6–7 (46.2%, n=13) | off yards ≥400 last: 6–7 (46.2%, n=13) → in stack 6–7 (46.2%, n=13)
- **Total 50.5** — tightest full-window cut clearing n = 20: Sunday night, total ≥47 — O–U 10–24 (29.4%, n=34).
- By season (O–U): 15:1-1 16:2-1 17:0-2 18:1-4 19:1-3 20:1-3 21:1-3 22:0-2 23:0-2 24:1-1 25:2-2
- Total margin (points – line): median -4.2, q25/q75 -11.0/+1.4; P(>+7) 0.15, P(<-7) 0.44
- **Walk-forward 11–8 in the training cut's direction (57.9%, n=19; raw O–U 8–11)** — cut chosen on seasons before N, printed on N; O/U after each year is the direction the training cut pointed. By year: 19:3-3U 20:1-3U 21:1-0U 22:0-0U 23:0-2U 24:1-1U 25:2-2U. OOS total margin median -4.0. Cuts picked: Sunday night, total ≥47 (3/7), Sunday night, outdoors, total ≥50 (2/7), outdoors, total ≥50 (1/7), Sunday night, total ≥50 (1/7).
- By total band: 45–49 6–9 (n=15); ≥50 4–15 (n=19)

## Appendix A. Sides — CAR +3.5

### CAR (home dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

| Cut                           | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| home dog                      | 168–169–8 | 49.9% | 345 |
| Sunday night home dog         | 10–8–1    | 55.6% | 19  |
| home dog +3.5 to +6.5         | 48–57     | 45.7% | 105 |
| Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5 | 10–11     | 47.6% | 21  |

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

| Cut                                                   | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| off EPA ≤ -1 last, home dog                           | 105–77–7  | 57.7% | 189 |
| off a loss as favorite, home dog +3.5 to +6.5         | 5–11      | 31.2% | 16  |
| off a loss as favorite, home dog                      | 16–25–1   | 39.0% | 42  |
| equal rest, home dog +3.5 to +6.5                     | 28–38     | 42.4% | 66  |
| scored ≤21 last, home dog                             | 109–92–7  | 54.2% | 208 |
| off an ATS miss, home dog +3.5 to +6.5                | 22–30     | 42.3% | 52  |
| next game is road, home dog +3.5 to +6.5              | 34–43     | 44.2% | 77  |
| allowed ≤21 last, home dog                            | 65–54–5   | 54.6% | 124 |
| allowed ≤21 last, Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5       | 4–7       | 36.4% | 11  |
| next game is road non-division, home dog +3.5 to +6.5 | 27–34     | 44.3% | 61  |
| off an ATS miss, Sunday night                         | 34–27–4   | 55.7% | 65  |
| bye next week, Sunday night                           | 13–9–1    | 59.1% | 23  |
| allowed ≤21 last, Sunday night                        | 31–38     | 44.9% | 69  |
| off a road game, home dog +3.5 to +6.5                | 32–39     | 45.1% | 71  |
| bye next week, home dog                               | 23–18     | 56.1% | 41  |
| success rate ≤ .40 last, home dog                     | 71–62–3   | 53.4% | 136 |
| equal rest, home dog                                  | 111–100–5 | 52.6% | 216 |
| off a road game, Sunday night                         | 38–32–4   | 54.3% | 74  |
| next game is road, home dog                           | 126–115–7 | 52.3% | 248 |
| success rate ≤ .40 last, Sunday night                 | 16–20–3   | 44.4% | 39  |
| opponent off a win, home dog                          | 105–96–4  | 52.2% | 205 |

| Cut                                          | ATS     | Pct   | n  |
|----------------------------------------------|---------|-------|----|
| outdoors, Sunday night home dog              | 6–4–1   | 60.0% | 11 |
| bye next week, home dog +3.5 to +6.5         | 6–4     | 60.0% | 10 |
| off a loss, Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5    | 4–6     | 40.0% | 10 |
| off a loss, home dog +3.5 to +6.5            | 30–35   | 46.2% | 65 |
| off EPA $\leq -1$ last, Sunday night         | 20–24–3 | 45.5% | 47 |
| next game is road, Sunday night              | 32–37–3 | 46.4% | 72 |
| off a loss, opponent off a win, Sunday night | 16–13–2 | 55.2% | 31 |

## Appendix B. Sides — DET –3.5

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

### DET (road favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

| Cut                           | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| road favorite                 | 169–168–8 | 50.1% | 345 |
| Sunday night road favorite    | 8–10–1    | 44.4% | 19  |
| road fav –3.5 to –6.5         | 57–48     | 54.3% | 105 |
| Sunday night fav –3.5 to –6.5 | 11–10     | 52.4% | 21  |

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

| Cut                                                   | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| road team from dome, outdoors, road favorite          | 46–30–1   | 60.5% | 77  |
| 0 turnovers last, Sunday night                        | 29–17–2   | 63.0% | 48  |
| next game is road, road fav –3.5 to –6.5              | 22–12     | 64.7% | 34  |
| scored $\geq 30$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5          | 24–14     | 63.2% | 38  |
| off a home game, road fav –3.5 to –6.5                | 41–28     | 59.4% | 69  |
| next game is road non-division, road fav –3.5 to –6.5 | 15–8      | 65.2% | 23  |
| success rate $\geq .50$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5   | 13–7      | 65.0% | 20  |
| off a 1-score win, Sunday night                       | 22–14–2   | 61.1% | 38  |
| off a 1-score win, road fav –3.5 to –6.5              | 19–12     | 61.3% | 31  |
| equal rest, road fav –3.5 to –6.5                     | 38–28     | 57.6% | 66  |
| scored 27–33 last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5              | 15–9      | 62.5% | 24  |
| scored $\geq 30$ last, Sunday night                   | 19–27–1   | 41.3% | 47  |
| 0 turnovers last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5               | 17–11     | 60.7% | 28  |
| opponent off an ATS miss, road fav –3.5 to –6.5       | 30–22     | 57.7% | 52  |
| off EPA $\geq +8$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5         | 26–19     | 57.8% | 45  |
| 0 turnovers last, road favorite                       | 45–54–1   | 45.5% | 100 |
| opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday night                | 27–34–4   | 44.3% | 65  |
| off a win as favorite, Sunday night                   | 26–32–2   | 44.8% | 60  |
| equal rest, road favorite                             | 100–111–5 | 47.4% | 216 |
| TO $\leq 1$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5               | 36–30     | 54.5% | 66  |
| next game is road non-division, road favorite         | 39–33–1   | 54.2% | 73  |
| off a home game, road favorite                        | 117–107–5 | 52.2% | 229 |
| off a win, road favorite                              | 96–105–4  | 47.8% | 205 |
| opponent off a loss, Sunday night fav –3.5 to –6.5    | 6–4       | 60.0% | 10  |
| outdoors, Sunday night road favorite                  | 4–6–1     | 40.0% | 11  |
| off EPA $\geq +8$ last, Sunday night road favorite    | 4–6       | 40.0% | 10  |
| off a home game, Sunday night                         | 29–34–2   | 46.0% | 65  |
| opponent off a loss, road fav –3.5 to –6.5            | 35–30     | 53.8% | 65  |

## Appendix C. Total 50.5 — n ≥ 10 cuts

| Cut                               | Over–Under | Over pct | n   |
|-----------------------------------|------------|----------|-----|
| Sunday night, outdoors, total ≥50 | 2–12       | 14.3%    | 14  |
| Sunday night, total ≥50           | 4–15       | 21.1%    | 19  |
| Sunday night, total ≥47           | 10–24      | 29.4%    | 34  |
| Sunday night, outdoors, total ≥47 | 6–17       | 26.1%    | 23  |
| outdoors, total ≥50               | 37–57–2    | 39.4%    | 96  |
| Sunday night                      | 26–43–1    | 37.7%    | 70  |
| outdoors, home dog, total ≥50     | 12–24      | 33.3%    | 36  |
| Sunday night, outdoors            | 19–32–1    | 37.3%    | 52  |
| home dog, total ≥50               | 23–33–2    | 41.1%    | 58  |
| Sunday night, home dog            | 12–7       | 63.2%    | 19  |
| outdoors, home dog                | 122–138–2  | 46.9%    | 262 |
| outdoors, total ≥47               | 109–124–3  | 46.8%    | 236 |
| total ≥50                         | 71–82–4    | 46.4%    | 157 |
| total ≥47                         | 167–179–5  | 48.3%    | 351 |
| outdoors, home dog, total ≥47     | 42–46      | 47.7%    | 88  |
| home dog                          | 167–174–4  | 49.0%    | 345 |
| outdoors                          | 343–350–7  | 49.5%    | 700 |
| home dog, total ≥47               | 61–63–2    | 49.2%    | 126 |

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats\_team\_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play\_by\_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).